

WEB APPLICATION DEVELOPMENT WITH NODE.JS

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05. EJS – *Embedded JavaScript templating*

What is EJS?

- What is the **"E"** for? **"Embedded?"** Could be. How about **"Effective," "Elegant,"** or just **"Easy"**?
- EJS is a simple templating language that lets you generate HTML markup with plain JavaScript. No religiousness about how to organize things. No reinvention of iteration and control-flow. It's just plain **JavaScript**.



Use plain JavaScript

We love JavaScript. It's a totally friendly language. All templating languages grow to be Turing-complete. Just cut out the middle-man, and use JS!



Fast development time

Don't waste time and attention figuring out arcane new syntax because 'elegance' — or how to preprocess your data so it will actually render right.



Simple syntax

JavaScript code in simple, straightforward scriptlet tags. Just write JavaScript that emits the HTML you want, and get the job done!



Speedy execution

We all know how fast V8 and the other JavaScript runtimes have gotten. EJS caches the intermediate JS functions for fast execution.



Easy debugging

It's easy to debug EJS errors: your errors are plain JavaScript exceptions, with template line-numbers included.



Active development

EJS has a large community of active users, and the library is under active development. We're happy to answer your questions or give you help.

Features

- **Fast** compilation and rendering
- **Simple** template tags: `<% %>`
- Custom delimiters (e.g., use `[? ?]` instead of `<% %>`)
- Sub-template includes
- Ships with CLI
- Both server JS and browser support
- Static caching of intermediate JavaScript
- Static caching of templates
- Complies with the Express view system

Using EJS with Express

- Install EJS with NPM

```
npm install ejs
```

```
app.get('/', (req, res) => {  
  let data = {  
    title: 'Hello World',  
    message: 'Welcome to my website!'  
  };  
  res.render('index', data);  
});
```

app.js

index.ejs

```
<h1><%= title %></h1>  
<p><%= message %></p>
```


Tags

- `<%` 'Scriptlet' tag, for control-flow, no output
- `<%=` 'Whitespace Slurping' Scriptlet tag, strips all whitespace before it
- `<%=` Outputs the value into the template (HTML escaped)
- `<%-` Outputs the unescaped value into the template
- `<%#` Comment tag, no execution, no output
- `<%%` Outputs a literal '`<%`'
- `%>` Plain ending tag
- `-%>` Trim-mode ('newline slurp') tag, trims following newline
- `_%>` 'Whitespace Slurping' ending tag, removes all whitespace after it

Includes

- Include sub template

```
<ul>  
<% users.forEach(function(user){ %>  
    <%- include('user/show', {user: user}); %>  
<% }); %>  
</ul>
```

users.ejs

user/show.ejs

```
<li><%= user %></li>
```

app.js

```
app.get('/users', function (req, res) {  
    let users = ['John', 'Jane', 'Doe'];  
    res.render('users', {users: users});  
});
```


Thank you!